sync and time the ball. Wasim just kept running and then, at some point, his left arm would blur and the ball would come skidding through at one helluva pace. He was also the master of late reverse-swing, and that ball of his that swung late and homed in on your toes was bladdy scary, let me tell you.

As I said, I didn't play against him too much, but there was one very memorable game when I played *with* him. In 2008, we were both invited to turn out for the Lashings World XI against Kent. It might have only been a Lashings match and therefore an invitational, semi-social game, but our bowling line-up included Allan Donald, Shoaib Akhtar, Franklyn Rose and Wasim Akram. Not a bad damn line-up at all. Incidentally, this was the first time I played with Sir Viv Richards as well.

Anyway, so we're playing at the Kent ground under lights – and if you know Kent, the lights are more like candles than lights – and Shoaib is charging in, bowling full-on, and our wicketkeeper, Junior Murray, is taking the ball at shoulder height. I mean, the ball is really hitting his gloves hard. I'm laughing myself silly at point, because these Kent guys aren't even close to laying bat on ball. They're just swatting at it, and after four overs they've got nothing – less than 10.

Our captain, Richie Richardson, looks at this lot and reckons, 'No boys, we can't have this. We can't massacre them; we need to give the fans their money's worth.' Sir Viv didn't like this one bit. I mean, he was really pissed off, saying, 'No, we didn't come here to make friends. We're here to beat these guys. Yes, we want to give the fans their money's worth, but we're not going to make it easy for the opposition.' The two of them are having this major argument out there in the middle, and you can basically see the steam coming out of Sir Viv's ears.

Richie is the captain and it is ultimately his decision, so he gives the ball to Jimmy Adams for a little bit. Unfortunately, that backfired, because the game eventually got away from us to such an extent that Kent ended up needing just six off the last over to win. You must understand that Lashings have only lost a couple of games since its inception in 1995. So Richie gives Wasim the ball … and Kent manages just two runs off the last over. Unbelievable bowling. Four balls in the blockhole, and a couple more that went flying past the batsmen. The Kent guys couldn't lay a bat on a ball. Fantastic stuff.